

Lab 2: Configure Your AI Workspace

Time: 45 minutes

What you need: Claude.ai Pro or Team account

Part 1: Configure Settings (10 min)

1. Click your profile icon → **Settings**
2. Review and configure each section:

Privacy & Security: - Verify "Improve Anthropic's models" is **OFF** (should be off on paid plans) - Review conversation history setting — leave ON unless working with sensitive data - Note the data handling policy for your plan tier

Model & Performance: - Set default model to **Claude Sonnet** (best daily driver) - Toggle on **Extended Thinking** — we'll use this later - Review response length preference

Profile: - Check your plan details and usage

Checkpoint: Take a screenshot of your Settings page. You'll reference this later.

Part 2: Write Personal Preferences (10 min)

1. Go to **Settings** → **Personal Preferences**

2. Write preferences that match YOUR work style. Here's a template to customize:

Role: [Your actual job title]
Industry: [Your industry]
Communication style: Direct and professional
Default format: Use headers and bullet points for long responses
When I ask for documents: Create them as artifacts I can copy
Always: Include specific examples, not generic advice
Never: Use jargon I haven't introduced first

1. **Test it:** Open a NEW conversation and ask:

"Write a summary of the benefits of AI for my team"

2. **Compare:** Open another NEW conversation, temporarily delete your preferences, and ask the same question.
3. Notice the difference? Restore your preferences.

Checkpoint: Your preferences are saved and tested.

Part 3: Build Your First Project (15 min)

1. Click **Projects** in the sidebar → **New Project**
2. Name it based on your actual job — examples:
3. "Weekly Reports" / "Client Proposals" / "Marketing Campaigns" / "Team Updates"
4. Write Custom Instructions (be specific):

This project helps me [specific task].
My audience is [who reads this output].

Use [formal/casual] tone.
Format output as [report/email/bullets/artifact].
Include [specific requirements for your work].

1. Upload at least one relevant file:
2. A document you regularly reference
3. A template you follow
4. Sample data you work with
5. OR use the provided `q4-sales-data.csv`
6. Ask Claude 3 questions in your Project:
7. One that uses your uploaded file
8. One that tests your custom instructions
9. One that you'd actually need for work this week

Checkpoint: You have a working Project with instructions and at least one file.

Part 4: Test Your Setup (10 min)

Run this comparison test:

1. **In a regular chat** (not your Project), ask:

"Create a weekly status update for my manager"

2. **In your Project**, ask the exact same question.
3. Compare the outputs:
4. Which one matches your work style better?
5. Which one required less editing?
6. Which one understood your context?

7. **Refine:** Based on what you see, update your Project's Custom Instructions. Add anything Claude got wrong or missed.
8. **Bonus:** Try asking Claude to help you improve your own Custom Instructions:

"Review my Project instructions and suggest improvements for better output quality"

What You Built

Setting	What You Configured
Privacy	Verified training opt-out, reviewed data handling
Model	Set default to Sonnet, enabled Extended Thinking
Preferences	Written and tested personal style guide
Project	Created with custom instructions + uploaded files

You now have a personalized AI workspace tailored to your job.

Tip: You can create multiple Projects for different work streams. Most power users have 3-5 active Projects.